Batman 2 Clues: Two-Face and the Court of Owls?

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"The Batman Part II" is currently filming, with Steven Soderbergh filling in as on-set director while Matt Reeves deals with a family crisis. The story is still a mystery: it hasn't even been confirmed which characters new cast members Sebastian Stan, Scarlett Johansson, Brian Tyree Henry and Charles Dance are playing. But rumors have swirled, and a new **leak** may have confirmed some of them.

For a long time, fans assumed Stan would play Harvey Dent, also known as Two-Face, with Johansson as his wife Gilda. But in June, reporter Jeff Sneider said Henry would play Dent instead, and Stan would play Victor Zsasz, a dangerous villain who would fit the dark world Reeves built in "The Batman."

That report looks more likely thanks to some detective work by fans. Supermodel Heidi Klum is famous for elaborate Halloween costumes, and Mike Marino, the makeup artist behind them, also worked on "The Batman" and is returning for "Part II." Fans spotted what look like props from the new movie in a video about Klum's costume: something like a cast of Henry's face with a **disfigured** lip, suggesting Two-Face, plus a box labeled "Zsasz" and another labeled "Owl 3."

That last box likely points to the Court of Owls, a secret society that has **manipulated** Gotham City from the shadows for hundreds of years in the comics. Created in 2011 by Scott Snyder and Greg Capullo, the Owls wear owl masks and send out **assassins** called Talons. Their original storyline is widely considered a modern classic, and many fans, including star Robert Pattinson, have long wanted them as sequel villains. That fits the first movie, which was about Bruce Wayne investigating **corruption** in Gotham: what if the rot goes even deeper and is centuries old? "The Batman Part II" is scheduled for release on February 18, 2028.

Word Treasure

disfigured -- A face changed from its normal shape by injury.
manipulated -- Secretly controlled events from behind the scenes.
assassins -- Trained fighters sent to carry out attacks.
leak -- Secret information that gets out before it should.
corruption -- Dishonest behavior by people in power.

Background you need

Batman is a fictional hero who protects Gotham City, a made-up city full of crime.

A sequel is a movie that continues the story of an earlier movie.

In movies, makeup artists design how actors look, including injuries or masks for villains.

A secret society in a story is a hidden group that works in the shadows to control events.

Break it down

LEAD: Batman 2 clues point to Two-Face and the Court of Owls
KEY EVENT: A leak hints at the casting
  +- OLD ASSUMPTION: Sebastian Stan as Harvey Dent
  +- NEW REPORT: Brian Tyree Henry as Dent, Stan as Zsasz
  +- CLUES: A face cast, a Zsasz box and an Owl 3 box
THE OWLS: A secret society with owl masks and Talons, created in 2011
RELEASE: February 18, 2028

Why it matters

Leaks and rumors show how fans piece together clues, and how a sequel can deepen a hero's world by revealing older, hidden threats.

Test what you remember

1. Who is filling in as on-set director?

- (A) Mike Marino
- (B) Steven Soderbergh
- (C) Jeff Sneider
- (D) Matt Reeves

2. According to the June report, who plays Dent?

- (A) Brian Tyree Henry
- (B) Scarlett Johansson
- (C) Charles Dance
- (D) Sebastian Stan

3. What did fans spot in the costume video?

- (A) Heidi Klum's costume
- (B) A new trailer
- (C) Props from The Batman Part II
- (D) The full movie

4. What does the Owl 3 box likely suggest?

- (A) Two-Face
- (B) Talons
- (C) Court of Owls
- (D) Victor Zsasz

5. When is Part II scheduled for release?

- (A) 2011
- (B) February 18, 2028
- (C) 2026
- (D) June

6. Who created the Court of Owls?

- (A) Steven Soderbergh
- (B) Scott Snyder and Greg Capullo
- (C) Robert Pattinson
- (D) Matt Reeves

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: C 4: C 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Jeff Sneider: Henry plays Dent and Stan plays Zsasz.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):